



What is statistics?

STATISTICS IS THE COLLECTION, ORGANIZATION, AND PROCESSING OF DATA.

Organizing and analyzing data helps make large quantities of information easier to understand. Graphs and other visual charts present information in a way that is instantly understandable.

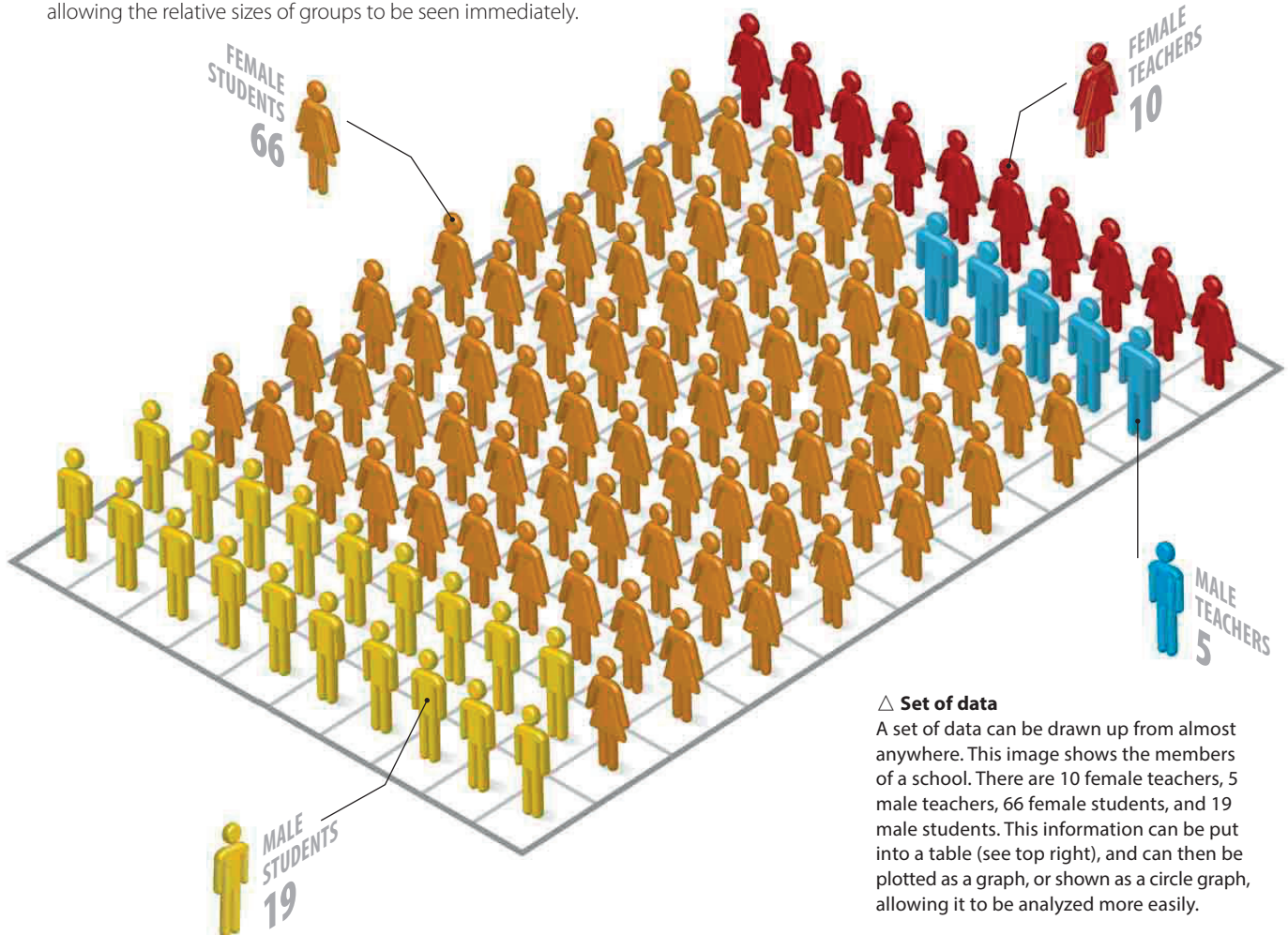
Working with data

Data is information, and it is everywhere, in enormous quantities. When data is collected, for example from a questionnaire, it often forms long lists that are hard to understand. It can be made easier to understand if the data is reorganized into tables, and even more accessible by taking the table and plotting its information as a graph or circle graph. Graphs show trends clearly, making the data much easier to analyze. Circle graphs present data in an instantly accessible way, allowing the relative sizes of groups to be seen immediately.

group	number
Female teachers	10
Male teachers	5
Female students	66
Male students	19
Total people	100

△ Collecting data

Once data has been collected, it must be organized into groups before it can be effectively analyzed. A table is the usual way to do this. This table shows the different groups of people in a school.



△ Set of data

A set of data can be drawn up from almost anywhere. This image shows the members of a school. There are 10 female teachers, 5 male teachers, 66 female students, and 19 male students. This information can be put into a table (see top right), and can then be plotted as a graph, or shown as a circle graph, allowing it to be analyzed more easily.